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1 **ABSTRACT**

2
3 **Objectives:** Fare capping, a policy in which a transit agency caps the maximum amount a rider pays over a given
4 period, has emerged as a recent innovation in public transit fare policy. The objective of this research is to compile and
5 compare fare capping policies across U.S. transit agencies and to explore potential rider benefits.

6
7 **Methods:** A multiple case study method was used to examine fare capping policies at the 101 largest transit agencies
8 in the United States. Agency fare policies were identified through publicly available documents, and daily, weekly, and
9 monthly caps were coded for each agency. The analysis calculated the number of one-way adult fares required to reach
10 each cap and compared the resulting discount patterns.

11
12 **Findings:** As of September 2021, fare capping was adopted by at least 21 of the 101 largest U.S. transit agencies.
13 Most daily fare caps offered little discount for a typical two-trip commuter, but daily caps provided more meaningful
14 discounts to transit-dependent riders, tourists, and other frequent riders.

15
16 **Novelty:** This paper provides one of the first systematic syntheses of fare capping policies across major U.S. transit
17 agencies. It also introduces a comparative framework based on cap structure, trip thresholds, and rider discount levels.

18
19 **Practical Applications:** The findings can help transit agencies design fare capping policies that better match rider
20 travel patterns and policy goals. Agencies can use the framework to compare operational contexts, equity goals, and
21 implementation constraints.

INTRODUCTION

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METHODS

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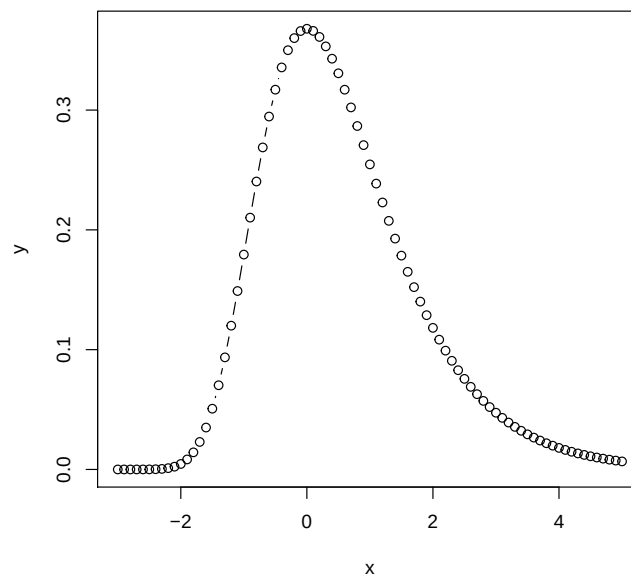


Figure 1 Caption for figure

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RESULTS

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When You Know	Multiply by	To Find
inches (in.)	25.4	millimeters (mm)
feet (ft)	0.305	meters (m)
yards (yd)	0.914	meters (m)
miles (mi)	1.61	kilometers (km)
acres	0.405	hectares (ha)

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DISCUSSION

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Equations are left aligned and should be introduced in the surrounding text:

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$$\dot{v}_\alpha = a \left[1 - \left(\frac{v_\alpha}{v_0} \right)^\delta - \left(\frac{s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha)}{s_\alpha} \right)^2 \right]. \quad (2)$$

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CONCLUSIONS

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AUTHOR CONTRIBUTIONS

The authors confirm contribution to the paper as follows: study conception and design: X. Author, Y. Author; data collection: Y. Author; analysis and interpretation of results: X. Author, Y. Author, Z. Author; draft manuscript preparation: Y. Author, Z. Author. All authors reviewed the results and approved the final version of the manuscript.

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